suspicion of his involvement in the Kakori train robbery case. Given that he was innocent of the charge the Kakori case had a big impact on Bhagat Singh's life. It haunted him. It was alleged that while that trial was going on in Lucknow he had gone there and that in an effort to secure the release of the accused, 'had procured some bombs, that by way of test one of the bombs was thrown in the crowd on the occasion of Dussehra 1926'. We know this because Bhagat Singh gives an account of this in his essay, 'Why I Am an Atheist'. Here he describes how,

> In May 1927, I was arrested in Lahore. This arrest came as a big surprise for me. I had not the slightest idea that I was wanted by the police. I was passing through a garden and all of a sudden the police surrounded me . . . I was taken into police custody. The next day I was taken to the Railway Police lockup where I spent a whole month. After many days' conversation with police personnel, I guessed that they had some information about my connection with the Kakori Party . . . They told me that I was in Lucknow during the Kakori Party Trial so that I might devise a scheme to rescue the culprits. They also said that after the plan had been approved, we procured some bombs and by way of test, one of those bombs was thrown into a crowd on the occasion of Dussehra in 1926. They offered to release me on condition that I gave a statement on the activities on of the Revolutionary Party. In this way I would be set free and even rewarded . . . I could not help laughing at their proposals. It was all humbug. People who have ideas like ours do not throw bombs at their own innocent people . . . I was completely innocent. [9]
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> They further informed me, in my interest, that if I could give any Statement throwing some light on the activities of the revolutionary party, I was not to be imprisoned but on the contrary set free and rewarded, even without being produced as an approver in court. I laughed at the proposal. It was all humbug.[10]

He was detained for five long weeks and only released on bail on the payment of an exorbitant Rs 60,000, offered by Dunichand, a fervent nationalist himself, and Daulat Ram, a philanthropist, leading to Bhagat Singh's release on 4 July 1927. It was perhaps the biggest bail amount set in Indian legal history up to that time. After Dr Gopichand Bhargava raised the matter in the Punjab Assembly, an inquiry was expedited, leading to the conclusion that there was no case against Bhagat Singh, and it was then that he was freed from bail altogether.